Information For the Use of
Salmeterol (50mcg) + Fluticasone Propionate (500 mcg) Capsules

# Flutialfa SF 500 Capsule

## FLUTIALFA SF 500 CAPSULE

**Salmeterol (50 mcg) + Fluticasone Propionate (500 mcg)**

### Composition

Each inhalation capsule contains:

- **Salmeterol – 50 mcg**
- **Fluticasone Propionate – 500 mcg**

### Pharmacological Action

Salmeterol is a long-acting $\beta_2$-adrenergic agonist (LABA), while fluticasone propionate is an inhaled corticosteroid (ICS) with potent anti-inflammatory activity.

It functions by:

- **Bronchodilation:** Salmeterol stimulates $\beta_2$ receptors in bronchial smooth muscle, producing prolonged bronchodilation and improving airflow.
- **Anti-inflammatory Action:** Fluticasone reduces airway inflammation and suppresses the release of inflammatory mediators.
- **Reduction in Airway Hyperresponsiveness:** Fluticasone helps reduce bronchial hyperreactivity and airway inflammation.
- **Combined Respiratory Action:** The combination provides sustained bronchodilation along with anti-inflammatory control of the airways.

### Indications

Flutialfa SF 500 Capsules are indicated for the maintenance treatment of:

- **Asthma** in patients requiring both an inhaled corticosteroid and a long-acting bronchodilator
- **Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD)** with persistent airflow limitation
- Reduction of respiratory symptoms and exacerbations in appropriately selected COPD patients
- Long-term control of airway inflammation and bronchoconstriction, as prescribed by the physician

**It is not intended for the relief of acute bronchospasm.**

### Dosage and Administration

- **Recommended Dose:** One inhalation capsule **twice daily**, approximately 12 hours apart, or as directed by the physician.

- **Administration:** For **oral inhalation only** using the appropriate inhalation device. **Do not swallow the capsule.**
- **After Use:** Rinse the mouth with water and spit it out after inhalation to reduce the risk of oral candidiasis and throat irritation.
- **Acute Symptoms:** A short-acting rescue bronchodilator should be used for immediate relief of acute bronchospasm when prescribed.
- **Duration of Use:** Continue regularly for the prescribed duration. Do not discontinue treatment abruptly without medical advice.

## Precautions

- **Pregnancy & Lactation:** Use during pregnancy or breastfeeding only when specifically advised by a healthcare professional.
- **Acute Bronchospasm:** This combination should not be used as rescue therapy for sudden breathing difficulty.
- **Cardiovascular Conditions:** Salmeterol may cause palpitations, tachycardia or other cardiovascular effects; use cautiously in susceptible patients.
- **Diabetes:** Monitor blood glucose in patients with diabetes or those at risk of hyperglycaemia.
- **Hypokalaemia:** $\beta_2$-agonists may cause a reduction in serum potassium, particularly at higher doses.
- **Oral Candidiasis:** Rinse the mouth after each inhalation to minimize the risk of fungal infection.
- **Adrenal Function:** Prolonged treatment with high-dose inhaled corticosteroids may cause systemic corticosteroid effects.
- **Infections:** Use cautiously in patients with existing infections or increased susceptibility to infections.
- **Bone & Eye Health:** Long-term corticosteroid therapy may affect bone mineral density and may be associated with ocular effects.

## Contraindications

- Known hypersensitivity to **salmeterol, fluticasone propionate** or any component of the formulation.
- Severe hypersensitivity to milk proteins, where the formulation contains lactose with milk-protein contamination.
- Primary treatment of **status asthmaticus** or other acute episodes requiring intensive treatment.
- Initiation of treatment during an acute or rapidly worsening episode of asthma or COPD.

## Adverse Reactions

**Common:**

- Headache
- Hoarseness or dysphonia
- Throat irritation
- Oral candidiasis
- Tremor
- Muscle cramps
- Palpitations

- Upper respiratory tract symptoms

**Rare but Serious:**

- Paradoxical bronchospasm
- Severe hypersensitivity reactions
- Significant cardiovascular effects
- Pneumonia, particularly in susceptible COPD patients
- Adrenal suppression
- Reduced bone mineral density with prolonged corticosteroid exposure
- Ocular complications with long-term corticosteroid use

Patients should seek medical attention for severe breathing difficulty immediately after inhalation, significant palpitations or severe allergic reactions.

## Drug Interactions

- **Other LABAs:** Concurrent use with another long-acting $\beta_2$-agonist should generally be avoided because of the risk of excessive $\beta_2$-agonist exposure.
- **β-Blockers:** May reduce the bronchodilator effect of salmeterol and may precipitate bronchospasm in susceptible patients.
- **Strong CYP3A4 Inhibitors:** Ketoconazole, ritonavir and other strong CYP3A4 inhibitors may increase systemic exposure to salmeterol and fluticasone.
- **Diuretics:** Non-potassium-sparing diuretics may increase the risk of $\beta_2$-agonist-associated hypokalaemia.
- **MAO Inhibitors/Tricyclic Antidepressants:** May enhance cardiovascular effects of salmeterol.
- Inform the physician about all prescription, OTC and herbal medicines being taken.

## Storage

- Store in a **cool, dry place**, protected from moisture and excessive heat.
- Keep capsules in their original packaging until immediately before use.
- Do not swallow the inhalation capsule.
- Keep out of reach of children.
- Follow the storage conditions specified on the approved product packaging.

## Note

This information is intended as a **professional pharmaceutical-literature guideline**. **Flutialfa SF 500 should be used under the supervision of a qualified healthcare professional.** The formulation is intended for regular maintenance therapy and **should not be used as a rescue medicine for acute bronchospasm**. The exact dose and approved indication should follow the product's regulatory-approved prescribing information.

Manufactured in India for:

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